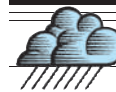


The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4

 **Showers 48/36 • Tomorrow: Snow, rain 39/19 B6** *Democracy Dies in Darkness* SATURDAY, JANUARY 18, 2025 • \$4

Supreme Court takes dispute on storybooks

Montgomery County case may affect how gender, sexuality can be taught

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL
AND NICOLE ASBURY

The Supreme Court agreed Friday to hear a case about whether public schools must give parents of elementary schoolchildren a chance to opt out of instruction on gender and sexuality that they say goes against their religious convictions.

The case stems from a challenge by a group of parents in Maryland's largest school system, who objected to Montgomery County Public Schools prohibiting parents from taking their children out of lessons that used storybooks with LGBTQ+ characters and themes.

Parents, who are Muslim, Roman Catholic and Ukrainian Orthodox, filed suit in 2023, saying the policy violates their First Amendment rights to freedom of religion.

The case puts the high court at the center of a contentious national debate over how to teach and treat gender and sexuality in schools, which has spurred fights over books, bathroom use and on which teams transgender athletes should be allowed to play.

Eric Baxter, an attorney for the families, said in a statement the school system's decision to dis-

SEE COURT ON A5

Bird flu leap will be early test for Trump

Serious cases in Canada, Louisiana show stakes for new health-care team

BY LENA H. SUN

By the time the 13-year-old arrived at the main children's hospital in Vancouver, British Columbia, in early November, a bird flu infection had robbed her ability to breathe. Pneumonia shrouded her left lung. Her kidneys were failing, her blood platelets plummeting.

Within four days, the previously healthy teen, whose initial symptoms were pink eye and fever, had deteriorated so dramatically that doctors at BC Children's Hospital had to deploy a battery of medical interventions to save her life. She was put on a mechanical ventilator to help her breathe. When that wasn't enough, medical teams turned to a last-resort treatment and for 17 days kept the adolescent alive with machines that forced air into and out of her lungs and oxygenated her blood externally to give her lungs a chance to heal.

Most of the more than five dozen people stricken with avian flu in an ongoing outbreak in the United States and Canada had mild symptoms and rebounded quickly. But the case of the Canadian teen — the only patient in North America to survive such a serious infection after a battery of sophisticated medical interven-

SEE BIRD FLU ON A6



MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

A worker catches his breath Friday at the National Mall as he and others remove the chairs they had previously set up. Donald Trump will now take the oath of office Monday in the Capitol Rotunda as temperatures outside are forecast to potentially drop below 20 degrees.

Icy blast sends inauguration inside

11th-hour decision spurs a scramble to adjust and upends plans months in the making

BY EMILY DAVIES,
MICHAEL BRICE-SADDLER
AND ELLIE SILVERMAN

President-elect Donald Trump on Friday ordered his inauguration moved indoors for the first time in four decades, a sudden weather-induced change that forced a scramble for hundreds of thousands of people who had spent months planning for the swearing-in of the nation's 47th president.

Law enforcement officials called

emergency meetings. Members of Congress learned about the change in the media, then fielded hundreds of calls from confused constituents who had tickets to the festivities. Workers inside the Capitol Rotunda, where Trump will now take the oath of office, quickly got to work assembling a new podium. And scores of people from across the country who had bought flights and booked hotels reconsidered their trips to the nation's capital.

"I wasn't worried at all," said Shanon

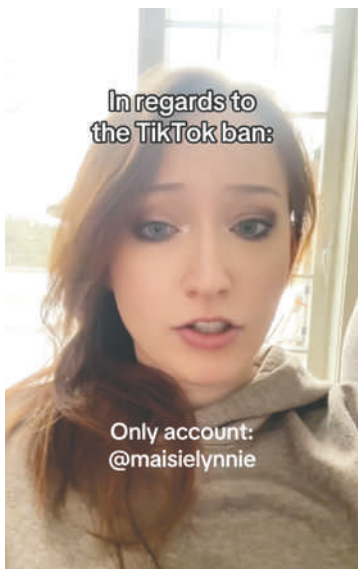
Randel Holm, a 41-year-old from Tampa, who had ordered ski pants and ice grips for the bottom of his shoes. He was scheduled to fly to D.C. on Saturday. "I figured it gets cold up north."

But the Arctic blast looming over the

SEE INAUGURATION ON A4

DHS hearing: Noem pledges to end Biden border control program if confirmed. **A4**

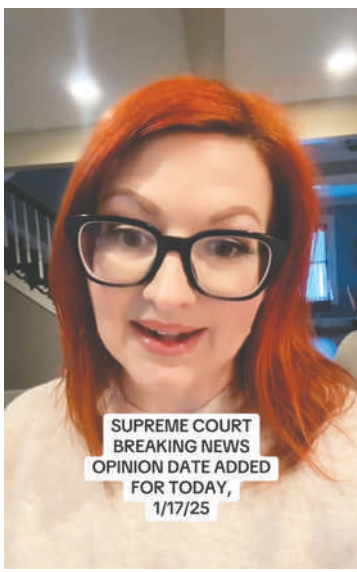
Trump resistance: Smaller protests are expected, in stark departure from 2017. **B1**



@MAISELYNNIE VIA TIKTOK



@ALLABOUTTHATCAR VIA TIKTOK



@TIFFANYCIANCI VIA TIKTOK

With TikTok set to be shut down in the United States as soon as Sunday, professional content-makers are rushing to prepare for a world without the app that redefined their livelihoods. Story, A14

Questions and answers: Can you still use TikTok when it's banned? Your guide to the coming shutdown. **A13**

A familial feeling: Former Vine stars offer advice amid the possible death of another social media platform. **C1**

Justices uphold TikTok's ban or sale

BY ANN E. MARIMOW AND
CRISTIANO LIMA-STRONG

The Supreme Court on Friday upheld a federal law that effectively bans TikTok in the United States on Sunday unless the wildly popular video-sharing app pulls off an unlikely, last-minute divestiture from Chinese ownership.

The unanimous decision was a major blow for TikTok, injecting deep uncertainty into the app's future with the deadline to sell the platform just two days away. President-elect Donald Trump,

Platform with more than 170 million U.S. users is set to go dark on Sunday

who has vowed to use his power to "save" the app, will be sworn in to office a day later.

No U.S. law has ever shut down a popular social media platform before, let alone one with more than 170 million users in the United States who rely on the app for news, entertainment

and self-expression.

Trump had asked the Supreme Court to delay implementation of the law to give him an opportunity to act once he returns to the White House. With the court declining that option and no sale of the app seemingly imminent, the ban is now poised to take effect the day before Trump's inauguration. TikTok said late Friday it will "go dark" without a late intervention by the Biden administration halting the law's enforcement.

The court's unsigned, 20-page

SEE TIKTOK ON A14

For these Commanders, late wins not dumb luck

Washington practices for decisive moments in games — and it shows

BY NICKI JHABVALA

Jayden Daniels barely even smiled. He had just led the Commanders on yet another game-winning drive and watched kicker Zane Gonzalez bank-shot the winning field goal to send Washington to the divisional round of the playoffs for the first time in 19 years.

Washington's sideline erupted in celebration while, across the field, Tampa Bay Buccaneers quarterback Baker Mayfield held his head in dismay.

But Daniels? "I think I was looking at Charlie," he told reporters, referencing senior manager of football communications Charlie Mule. "He was like, 'We've got some interviews.' I don't know. I can't even tell you."

Another game, another walk-off win, another even-keeled response from the rookie who has time and again done the unthinkable to turn around a franchise that not long ago appeared unsalvageable.

The Commanders head to Detroit on Saturday night to face one of the NFL's best teams in the divisional round, a reality few could have seen coming in the

first year of their latest rebuild. Yet the Commanders have done more than just set records and inspire optimism.

Quite simply, they've thrived. Washington has won its past five games (and seven total this season) on the last play from scrimmage — a feat so rare, so absurd, so unlike the Commanders of the past, that their road to Detroit will long be remembered.

In Week 15, Washington overcame a bevy of mistakes in New Orleans to stop a two-point attempt by the Saints at the end of regulation and preserve a win. Then in Week 16, Daniels threw the game-winning touchdown to Jamison Crowder to upset the Philadelphia Eagles. The next week, Daniels threw a touchdown pass to tight end Zach Ertz in overtime to defeat the Atlanta Falcons and punch the Commanders' ticket to the playoffs. Backup quarterback Marcus Mariota finished the regular season with the game-winning touchdown throw to Terry McLaurin at Dallas, and then Daniels guided Washington to its first-round win in Tampa with a methodical, clock-eating, 10-play drive that Gonzalez sealed.

Washington is the first team since the 1970 AFL-NFL merger to win four consecutive games with the winning score coming in the final 10 seconds of regulation or

SEE COMMANDERS ON A7

Brewer: For Quinn and Campbell, coaching is every bit a passion. **D1**

IN THE NEWS

A matter of clemency President Joe Biden said he is commuting the sentences of nearly 2,500 people convicted of nonviolent drug offenses. **A3**

A tough sell Maryland Gov. Wes Moore pitched a politically perilous idea: tax increases on the wealthy. **B1**

THE NATION **A former CIA analyst** pleaded guilty to leaking records on Israeli military movements. **A3** **The Los Angeles** fires upended hard-won stability for many homeless people. **A8**

THE WORLD **Taiwan** may cut its defense even as China ramps up its threats. **A9** **The Biden** administration sanctioned two players in Chinese hacks of the U.S. Treasury and telecom firms. **A11**

THE ECONOMY **Alcohol sales** are down, with many younger adults drinking in moderation or not at all. **A12** **Apple** temporarily disabled an artificial intelligence feature that incorrectly summarized news articles on iPhones. **A13**

THE REGION **Two people** died after a crash on the Arlington Memorial Bridge sent a pickup into the icy Potomac River. **B1** **The last member** of the Oath Keepers charged in connection with the Jan. 6, 2021, riots at the U.S. Capitol was sentenced to prison. **B1**

OBITUARIES **Joan Plowright**, 95, forged a varied acting career and protected the legacy of husband Laurence Olivier. **B4**

STYLE **CNN** agreed Friday to settle a lawsuit filed by Zachary Young, who sued the network for defamation in 2022. **C1**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A12
COMICS.....C7
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WORLD NEWS.....A9

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